



Mid-range TWS earphones

Hitting the sweet spot of your wallet, and also hitting the right notes

Nestling snugly between the budget and premium truly wireless earphones categories, the mid-range TWS segment has made significant strides in 2024. After a relatively quiet year in 2022, the ₹5-10K segment has seen a revival, with brands stepping up their game to meet the growing demand for feature-rich, value-packed devices. This year, the segment witnessed key launches from brands such as Sony, Nothing, JBL, and Oppo, delivering a much-needed boost to the category. Let's dive in to discover which devices earned these prestigious accolades this year.

Winner: OnePlus Buds 3

The OnePlus Buds 3 offer a familiar sound signature for those accustomed to the brand's earbuds. Featuring a U-shaped sound profile, these buds bring a bass boost that ensures a punchy low end, without descending into muddiness. The highs are also given a lift to create balance, but this boost does introduce a slight bit of sibilance. However, this doesn't detract from the overall performance, and vocal-heavy tracks fare well. OnePlus has done a commendable job here, balancing the low-end and treble while maintaining clarity in most scenarios. The microphone performs well in quiet environments, ensuring clear calls. However, in noisy situations, such as walking down a busy road, the mic struggles to



OnePlus Buds 3
Price: ₹5,499

isolate your voice from surrounding sounds. Active Noise Cancellation (ANC) works effectively in most cases, though it occasionally lets in some sharp, erratic noise. Despite these minor drawbacks, the fit and isolation are solid overall. All this put together, made these earbuds our top choice for the Digit Zero1 Awards 2024 in the Mid-range TWS earphones category.

Runner-Up and Best Buy: Nothing ear (a)

The Nothing Ear (1) is priced at ₹7,999 (at the time of release), and for what it offers, it's honestly a steal. With 11.6 mm drivers under the hood and support for SBC and AAC codecs, these earbuds pack a punch while keeping things simple and accessible across devices. When it comes to sound, the Ear (1) hits a sweet spot. The bass is punchy enough to add excitement to your tracks without drowning out the rest of the mix. The mids, while slightly pulled back, still manage to keep vocals and instruments clear and present. As for the highs, they've got just the right amount of zing—bright and crisp without becoming too sharp. The soundstage feels decently spacious, making these great for everything from pop hits to mellow acoustics. The Active Noise Cancellation (ANC) here is impressive for the price, easily cutting out low-frequency hums like your office AC or a running fan. Transparency Mode works well too, letting you stay aware of your surroundings when needed. These aren't features you'd expect to see at this price, but Nothing delivers them with style. Stacking these up against the OnePlus Buds 3, the Ear (1) comes remarkably close. The Buds 3 slightly edge them out with more balanced mids, taking the Zero1 Award, but the Ear (1) fights back with bass that packs a little more oomph and its eye-catching, minimalist design. Battery life is solid, giving you about 5.7 hours of playback on a single charge (ANC off) and up to 34 hours with the case. Add to that the lightweight build and those cool transparent earbuds, and you've got a package that's hard to beat for the price. The Nothing Ear (1) isn't just good – it's a seriously smart buy, and was the best of the rest when it came to the Digit Best Buy Awards 2024, in the Mid-range TWS earphones category.

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